



The Time Editor: Keep Verb Tenses Consistent

Grade 5 • Delaware • Grammar / writing

CCSS.ELA-Literacy.L.5.1.d

Recognize and repair inappropriate tense shifts while preserving intended time. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 5 • Delaware • Grammar / writing; CCSS.ELA-Literacy.L.5.1.d. Focus: Recognize and repair inappropriate tense shifts while preserving intended time.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

Choose a time frame, then keep verbs consistent unless the meaning genuinely moves to another time. Words such as yesterday, now, and tomorrow can justify a shift. Do not change every verb blindly; explain when the event happens. This packet targets tense consistency, not a full verb-tense course.

Model 1 • Fix: Yesterday I pack a bag and walked to school.

Yesterday I packed a bag and walked to school. Both events occurred in the past.

Model 2 • Is this shift appropriate: I practiced yesterday, and I will perform tomorrow?

Yes. The time words explicitly separate past practice from future performance.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Editing checklist

1. Circle a time clue. 2. Identify each verb. 3. Decide whether the time actually changes. 4. Correct only mismatched verbs. 5. Reread for meaning. If no time clue exists, more than one consistent revision may be valid.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Fix: Last night we watch a film and discussed it.

2. Fix: Every morning Ana opens the window and watered the plant.

3. Fix: Tomorrow I will label the jars and stored them.

4. Fix: Yesterday Ben writes a note, folded it, and mailed it.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Is a shift justified: We lived there in 2020, but we live here now? Explain.

6. Is a shift justified: Yesterday I bake a loaf and sliced it? Explain.

7. Fix: Each week the club meets and planned an activity.

8. Fix: Next Saturday we will sweep and painted the room.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Rewrite in past: I draw a map and mark the path.

10. Rewrite in present habit: She carried books and greeted neighbors.

11. Rewrite in future: They measure and cut the board.

12. Keep the real time change: I studied yesterday; today I review. Must both be past?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Fix consistently: The child opened the box, sees a kite, and smiled.

14. Fix: Water dripped from the roof while we wait yesterday.

15. Write a two-sentence past-tense account of preparing a meal.

16. Add one sentence about tomorrow without creating an error.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. Fix: Last week the team designs a logo and printed signs.

18. Fix: Every day I checked the shelf and return books.

19. Explain why this works: I knew the route then, but I need a map now.

20. Write three connected sentences: past, present, future. Mark time clues.



Answers and response criteria

1. Last night we watched a film and discussed it.
2. Every morning Ana opens the window and waters the plant.
3. Tomorrow I will label the jars and store them. Will applies to both coordinated verbs.
4. Yesterday Ben wrote a note, folded it, and mailed it.
5. Yes; 2020 and now indicate different times.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. No; both events yesterday require baked and sliced.

7. Each week the club meets and plans an activity.

8. Next Saturday we will sweep and paint the room.

9. I drew a map and marked the path.

10. She carries books and greets neighbors.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. They will measure and cut the board.

12. No. Yesterday studied is past; today review is present. Meaning justifies the shift.

13. The child opened the box, saw a kite, and smiled. All past.

14. Water dripped from the roof while we waited yesterday.

15. Require past verbs throughout unless a justified different time is explicit. Any invented meal accepted.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Use an explicit future marker and future verb, e.g., Tomorrow I will try another recipe.

17. Last week the team designed a logo and printed signs.

18. Every day I check the shelf and return books, for present habit; also accept checked/returned with clearly past habit context.

19. Then and now justify past knew and present need.

20. Example: Yesterday I planned. Today I gather supplies. Tomorrow I will build. Each time clue matches its tense.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://education.delaware.gov/educators/academic-support/standards-and-assessments/english-and-language-arts/standards/>

State-linked standard text • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://www.thecorestandards.org/ELA-Literacy/L/5/>

DDOE assessment overview • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://education.delaware.gov/educators/academic-support/standards-and-assessments/english-and-language-arts/assessments/>

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